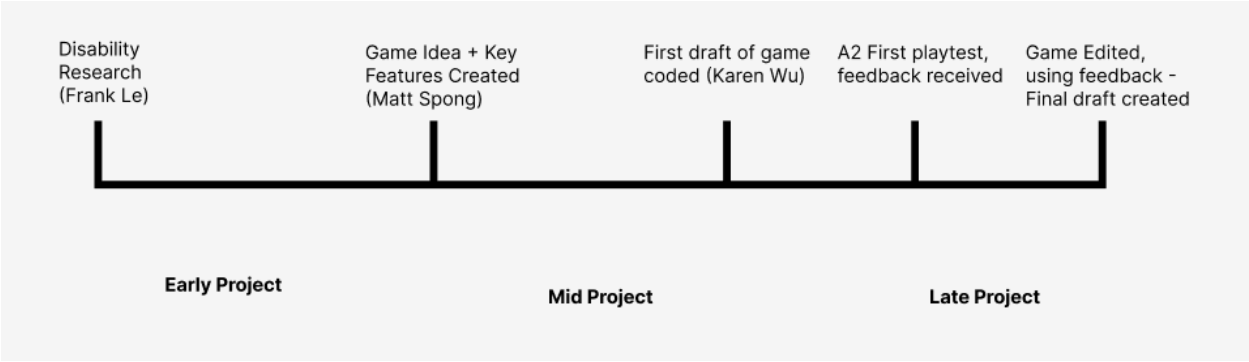
Process & Decision Documentation

Process Overview Visualization (Group Work Only)



Project/Assignment Decisions

Major Decisions:

Decision 1: The game idea was created by Matt Spong and Frank Le, using Frank's research. They wanted to create a game that was simple, thus easy to code and debug, without sacrificing the intensity of gameplay. They used a simple square colour matching puzzle to challenge the player, and a timer element to increase the anxiety of the player. Instead of using the original idea, a Rubics cube like puzzle, with a 3D design to add complexity, they decided on a 2D grid, with a colour-swapping core mechanic to keep the code simple and not overwhelm new players.

Decision 2: Addition of Pop-ups. Because the game was not anxiety-inducing enough, Matt Spong decided to add the Pop-ups, which needed to be clicked immediately or the game was unplayable, to add more stress to the player.

Decision 3: Matt Spong and Karen Wu decided to create the game with an extreme difficulty level, making it hard for beginners to learn, in order to greatly increase the anxiety of new players. This was done by increasing the frequency of the Pop-ups, which slows

down the player. This, however, received complaints in the user testing, as players found it much too difficult.

Decision 4: Karen Wu decided to include a starter level, which was recommended by some player testers to lower the difficulty and make the game more playable. This decision lowers the overall anxiety of the game, but makes it much more accessible, which she felt was a worthwhile trade-off.

Role-Based Process Evidence

Early Game Mock-ups and Workflow

Created by: Matt Spong: UX & Experience Designer

Used by: Karen Wu: Technical Director/Lead Developer

Early Game Ideas, Mechanics and Functions

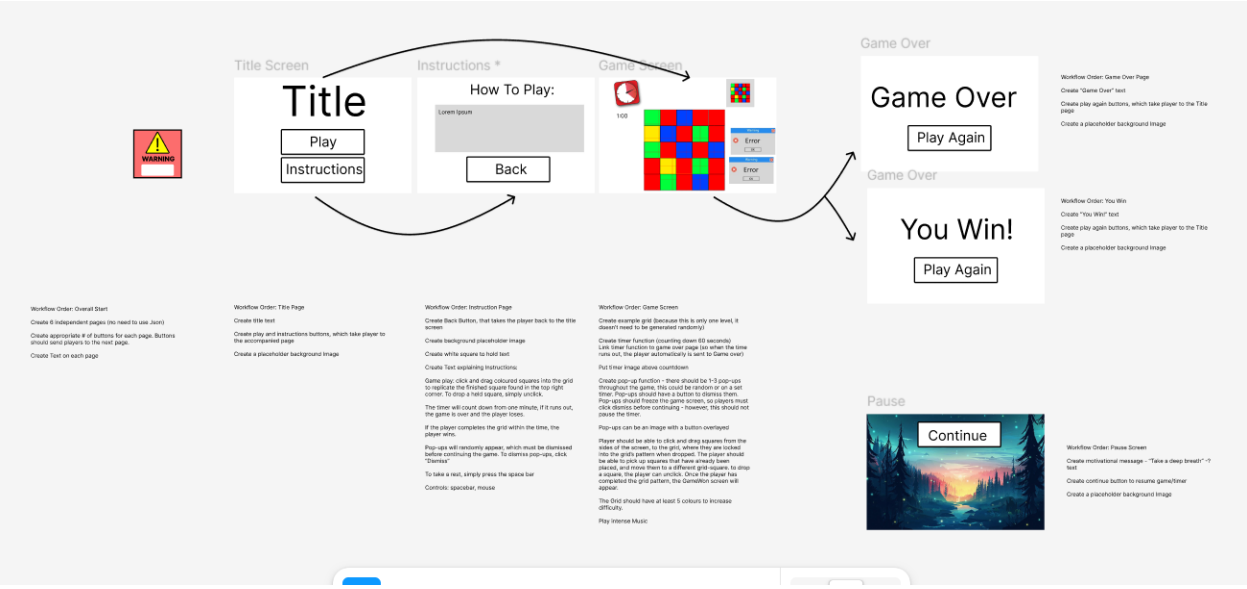
Created by: Frank Le: Research & Ethics Lead and Matt Spong: UX & Experience Designer

Used by: Karen Wu: Technical Director/Lead Developer

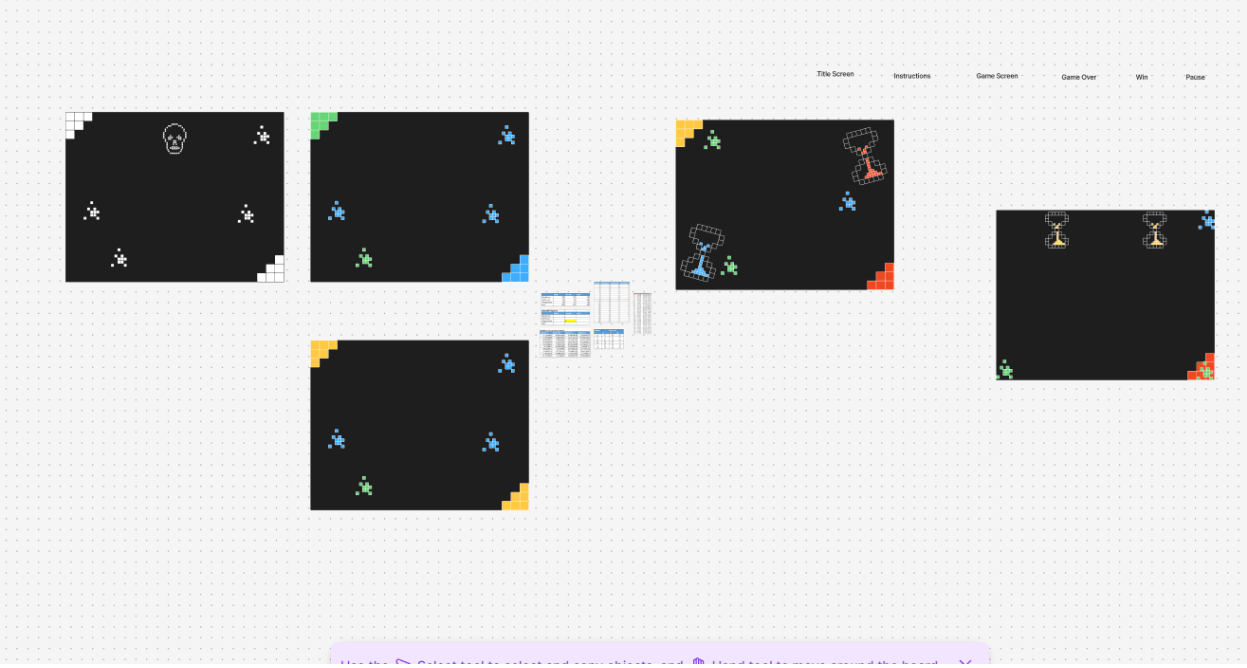
Game Design Pages

Created by: Matt Spong: UX & Experience Designer

Used by: Karen Wu: Technical Director/Lead Developer


Title Screen
Title
Play
Instructions
Instructions *
How To Play:
Lorem Ipsum
Back
Game Screen
100
Error
Error
Game Over
Game Over
Play Again
Game Over
You Win!
Play Again
Pause
Continue
Workflow Order: Overall Start
Create 6 independent pages (no need to use Jacn)
Create appropriate # of buttons for each page. Buttons should send players to the next page.
Create Text on each page
Workflow Order: Title Page
Create title text
Create play and instructions buttons, which take player to the accompanied page
Create a placeholder background image
Workflow Order: Instruction Page
Create Back Button, that takes the player back to the title screen
Create background placeholder image
Create white square to hold text
Create Text explaining instructions:
Game play: click and drag coloured squares into the grid to replicate the finished square found in the top right corner. To drop a held square, simply unclick.
The timer will count down from one minute, if it runs out, the game is over and the player loses.
If the player completes the grid within the time, the player wins.
Pop-ups will randomly appear, which must be dismissed before continuing the game. To dismiss pop-ups, click "Dismiss"
To take a rest, simply press the space bar
Controls: spacebar, mouse
Workflow Order: Game Screen
Create example grid (because this is only one level, it doesn't need to be generated randomly)
Create timer function (counting down 60 seconds)
Link timer function to game over page (so when the time runs out, the player automatically is sent to Game over)
Put timer image above countdown
Create pop-up function - there should be 1-3 pop-ups throughout the game, this could be random or on a set timer. Pop-ups should have a button to dismiss them. Pop-ups should freeze the game screen, so players must click dismiss before continuing - however, this should not pause the timer.
Pop-ups can be an image with a button overlayed
Player should be able to click and drag squares from the sides of the screen, to the grid, where they are locked into the grid's pattern when dropped. The player should be able to pick up squares that have already been placed and move them to a different grid-square to drop a square, the player can unclick. Once the player has completed the grid pattern, the GameOver screen will appear.
The Grid should have at least 5 colours to increase difficulty.
Play Intense Music
Workflow Order: Game Over Page
Create "Game Over" text
Create play again buttons, which take player to the Title page
Create a placeholder background image
Workflow Order: You Win
Create "You Win!" text
Create play again buttons, which take player to the Title page
Create a placeholder background image
Workflow Order: Pause Screen
Create motivational message - "Take a deep breath" -? text
Create continue button to resume game/timer
Create a placeholder background image

A2 Mood Board
Page 1
Title Screen
Instructions
Game Screen
Game Over
Viewing Mar 4, 4:08 PM


Title Screen
Instructions
Game Screen
Game Over
Win
Pause

Key Game Ideas:

Create an anxiety inducing game that uses intense music, a timer and pop-up distractions to create an environment of stress/anxiety - while also using peaceful, slow and stress-free mechanics to take the player out of their environment to highlight the importance of anti-anxiety techniques.

Gameplay

The gameplay itself is based on a simple timed puzzle solver game - but to make it more simple, you just need to arrange colourful squares to match the guide image.

Mechanics:

Stress Inducing:

Timer:
1:00 timer counting down to a game over screen

Pop-ups:
Small pop-up tabs containing a small message and a button to close the tab. Pop-ups will lock the screen, forcing the player to close each pop-up before continuing the puzzle

Music:
3 levels, increasing in tempo depending on how close player is to running out of time

Stress Mitigating:

Pause Screen:
Having a "pause" function, that opens a pause screen without clutter (little to no buttons) - opens with the press of a major button, like space at anytime during game play. This feature helps mitigate "disability tourism" and juxtaposes the anxiety inducing gameplay. By having this feature it can help show player the importance of anxiety relief strategies (maybe include some breathwork graphics in the pause screen to show specific strategies). This can also amplify the anxiety of the actual gameplay, because the change from light, stress-free pause menu and intense gameplay is so dramatic.

Pause screen aesthetic could include:

-Soft pastel colouring
-Animals grazing in background
-soft music playing

-a message encouraging players to take a deep breath
-minimized buttons or clutter (maybe no buttons)
-cute cartoon/drawn characters

Screens:

-Title Screen (Possibly with no instructions/ vague instructions to heighten a sense of anxiety)

-Game screen

-Pause Screen

-Game over screen

GenAI Documentation

Date Used: March 4, 2026 at 06:12 PM

Tool Disclosure: Gemini 3 Flash

Purpose of Use: To solve coding issues and debug

Summary of Interaction: It solved a formatting issue early in the creation of the first page. It edited code later in the project to add elements to the pages (Rectangle).

Human Decision Point(s): Some of the changes that Gemini made were ugly to the human eye, because of this, elements like rectangles and buttons were moved.

Integrity & Verification Note: All Gemini code was tested before added to make sure it worked properly.

Scope of GenAI Use: The majority of elements were created by Karen Wu, who created a layout of all required elements, pages and features.

Limitations or Misfires: Gemini created some ugly pages, and formatting errors that stuck out to the human eye.

Summary of Process (Human + Tool)

Gemini was used to build elements that were too complicated for the group's collective coding ability. These iterations were throughout most of the project stages, providing the most help early on. These are mainly formatting fixes. Early in the project Ai helped to create a number of page elements. Later on, a hover effect was debugged using Gemini.

Decision Points & Trade-offs

The decision to use AI was made collectively by the group to reduce the time cost of coding. The Ai helped to supplement our poor coding skills, yet it prevented us from "learning by doing", as our bugs were easily removed by the Ai.

Verification & Judgement

Every change that Ai made was run through the code before adding it to the project, to check the quality of the edits. Some placement issues had to be fixed before moving on, like changing coords of elements.

Appendix

AI Transcript:

https://gemini.google.com/share/d3f4b0056ef7